



# Winter storm & outage checklist

Prepare for several days of disruption, including roads, water and communication.

## BEFORE THE STORM

- ☐ Register for CruzAware at [cruzaware.org](https://cruzaware.org) and add multiple contact methods. Set up PG&E outage alerts and keep your contact details current.
- ☐ Save PG&E outage reporting: **800-743-5002**. County road dispatch: **831-477-3999**.
- ☐ Check the National Weather Service forecast and official road information. Clear accessible drains before rain; hire help for roofs and hazardous trees.
- ☐ Store at least one gallon of drinking water per person per day for at least three days, plus water for pets. A well pump may stop without electricity.
- ☐ Stock shelf-stable food, a manual can opener, flashlights, batteries, radio and charged power banks.
- ☐ Use appliance thermometers. Keep refrigerator temperature at or below 40°F and freezer at or below 0°F.
- ☐ Test smoke and carbon monoxide alarms, including battery backup. Put CO alarms near sleeping areas.
- ☐ Plan backup power and a safe place to relocate for medical equipment. Record battery runtime and when to leave. PG&E Medical Baseline does not guarantee uninterrupted electricity.
- ☐ Ask your pharmacist about each medicine's storage limits and backup cooling. Keep those instructions with the medicine.
- ☐ Arrange a voluntary check-in plan with neighbors and anyone who may need help. Share only the personal information you want to share.

## IF YOU USE A GENERATOR

Plan a safe outdoor location and follow the manufacturer's instructions. Have a qualified electrician install approved equipment before connecting a generator to household wiring. **Never plug it into a wall outlet.** Store fuel safely outside living spaces and away from ignition sources.

PG&E may use a Public Safety Power Shutoff during dry, windy fire weather. Storm damage can also cause long outages. Don't rely on advance notice or an estimated restoration time.

## OFFICIAL SOURCES

[CDC: emergency water storage](#)



# When the power goes out

Use current official instructions. Missing information never means conditions are safe.

**Downed line:** stay away from it and anything it touches. Call 911, then PG&E at 800-743-5000.

**Gas smell:** leave the area first, then call 911 and PG&E from a safe place.

- ☐ Report an unlisted outage to PG&E. Unplug sensitive electronics; leave one light on to show when power returns.
- ☐ Run portable generators **outside, at least 20 feet from any doors, windows or vents**, with exhaust directed away from buildings. Never in a garage, even with the door open.
- ☐ Keep the generator dry without enclosing it, use correctly rated cords, and turn it off and let it cool before refueling. Never heat a home with a grill, camp stove or gas oven.
- ☐ Keep refrigerator and freezer doors closed. A refrigerator holds food safely about **4 hours**; a full freezer about **48 hours**, or **24 hours** if half full.
- ☐ Discard refrigerated perishables after 4 hours without power unless kept at or below 40°F. Discard food left at room temperature for 2 hours (1 hour if above 90°F). Never taste food to test safety.
- ☐ Frozen food can be refrozen if it still has ice crystals or is at or below 40°F.
- ☐ If medicine leaves its recommended temperature range, check its instructions and promptly contact a pharmacist, clinician or manufacturer. Don't wait a full day to ask.
- ☐ Follow water-provider notices. SLV Water District: **831-338-2153**. Follow the notice's specific instructions; don't assume boiling fixes every kind of contamination.
- ☐ Avoid flooded roads, downed trees and slides. Never drive around a closure or through floodwater. Check on neighbors only when it's safe to do so.

## OFFICIAL SOURCES

[FDA: food safety during outages](#)

[FDA: medicine after a natural disaster](#)

[CDC: safe generator use](#)

[National Weather Service: flood safety](#)

[County alert registration](#)

[PG&E contacts](#)

[PG&E Medical Baseline: service is not guaranteed](#)